

Ephesus

An important port in Greek and Roman times, and later a place of Christian pilgrimage

Situated on the Ionian coast of present-day Turkey, Ephesus was first settled by the Greeks in about 1200 BCE and became one of the most prosperous cities of ancient Greece. After a period of Persian occupation from the 6th century BCE, it was recaptured by one of Alexander the Great's generals in 334 BCE and effectively refounded on a new site to the west to bring it nearer to the receding coastline.

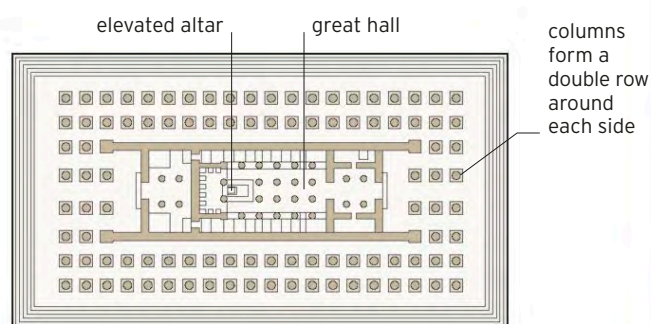
The regenerated Ephesus boasted many fine buildings, including the famous Temple of Artemis, but sadly excavation has uncovered only fragments of the Hellenistic city. However, Ephesus underwent further rebuilding after it was acquired by the Roman empire, and much of the Roman city has survived. The splendor of its architecture was symbolic of Roman wealth and colonial supremacy. With a sophisticated infrastructure of streets and aqueducts, Roman Ephesus contained many fine public buildings, including a theater, the Library of Celsus, and the Temple of Hadrian.

▷ ROMAN EPHESUS

The best-preserved buildings of Ephesus date from the period of Roman rule, from the 2nd century CE. This magnificent facade of the Library of Celsus is an example of such well-preserved remains.

THE TEMPLE OF ARTEMIS

The third temple built on this site, begun in 323 BCE, was the largest of its kind ever constructed—larger even than the Athenian Parthenon—and hailed as one of the Seven Wonders of the World. It was about 377 ft (115 m) long and 180 ft (55 m) wide, with a double row of columns, each about 60 ft (18 m) high and 4 ft (1.2 m) in diameter.



Paul the Apostle preached in the **theater** while **visiting** Ephesus

